Path of Ascension – Project 1 Proposal

CSC 4370 – Web Programming

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Selected Topic Track: Quest Explorer
Extension Pack: Adventure Pack
Bonus Feature: None planned initially

Date: October 4, 2026

Project Overview

Path of Ascension is a fantasy/xianxia-themed Quest Explorer website that allows users to explore a cultivation world, discover different regions, view quests, and follow a cultivator's progression through their journey. The website will include four main pages: a Home page that introduces the world and journey, a World Map that displays explorable regions and progression checkpoints, a Mission Detail page that provides information about a selected quest, and a Team/About page that introduces important characters and their roles. The Adventure Pack will be incorporated through a route and checkpoint system that visually represents the user's progression through the world. The website will use only HTML and CSS and will emphasize responsive layouts, clear navigation, accessible interactions, and CSS-based visual effects and animations.

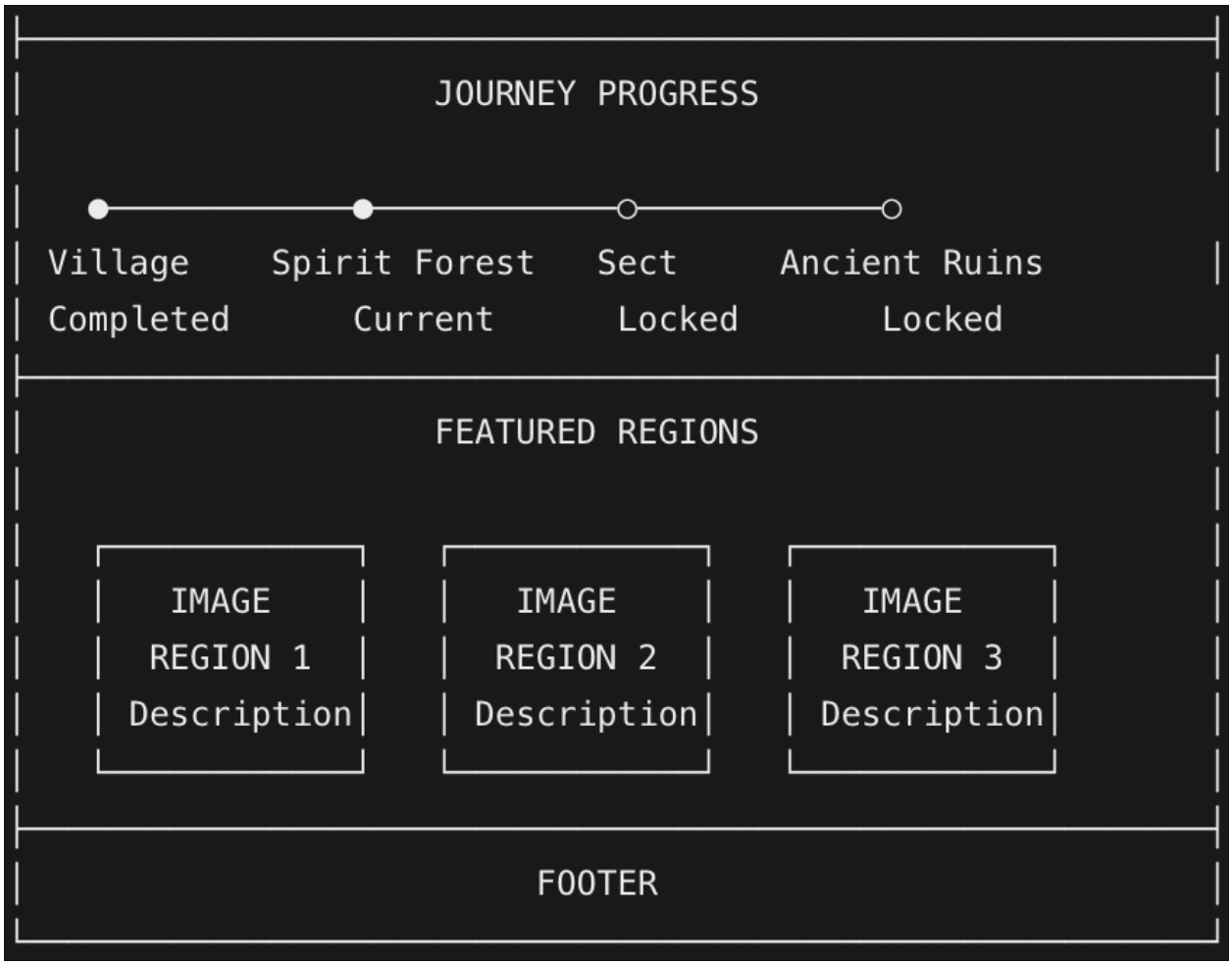
The visitor will follow a newly awakened cultivator beginning their journey through several increasingly dangerous regions. Each location represents another stage of their path toward ascension, with quests, challenges, rewards, and checkpoints revealing their progression.

Proposed Wireframe

Homepage (index.html)

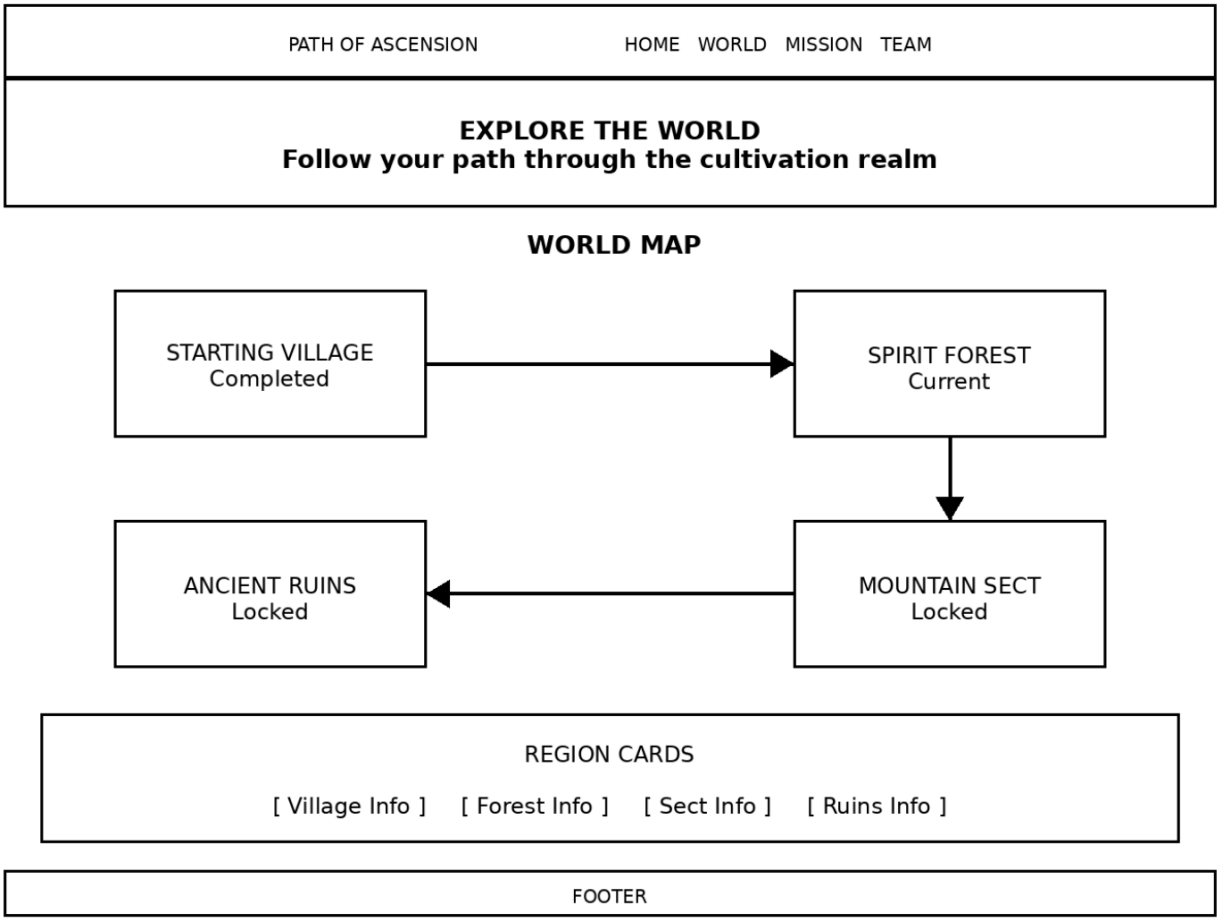
The Home page will introduce *Path of Ascension* and establish the xianxia/cultivation theme of the website. It will include a navigation bar, a large hero section containing the

site's title and a short introduction to the cultivator's journey, and a call-to-action that directs users toward the World Map. The page will also preview important regions and the current stage of the journey so users can quickly understand the purpose of the website.



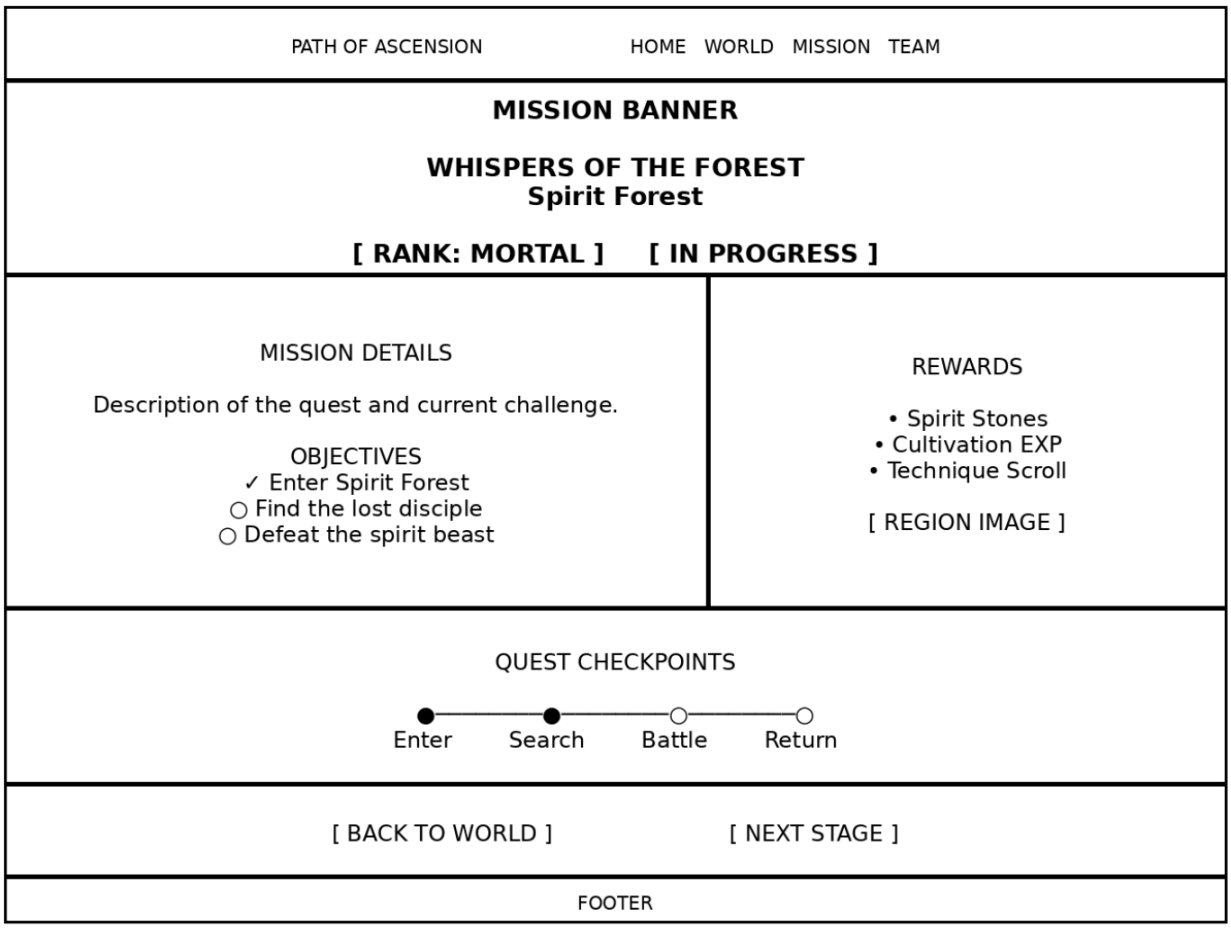
World Map (world.html)

The World Map will serve as the primary exploration page. It will display several regions of the cultivation world, such as the Starting Village, Grey Spirit Forest, Blue Mountain Sect, and Ancient Azure Ruins. The regions will be organized using CSS Grid and will include cards containing a region's name, description, difficulty, and status. The Adventure Pack will be incorporated through a visual route connecting progression checkpoints and showing which locations are completed, current, or upcoming.



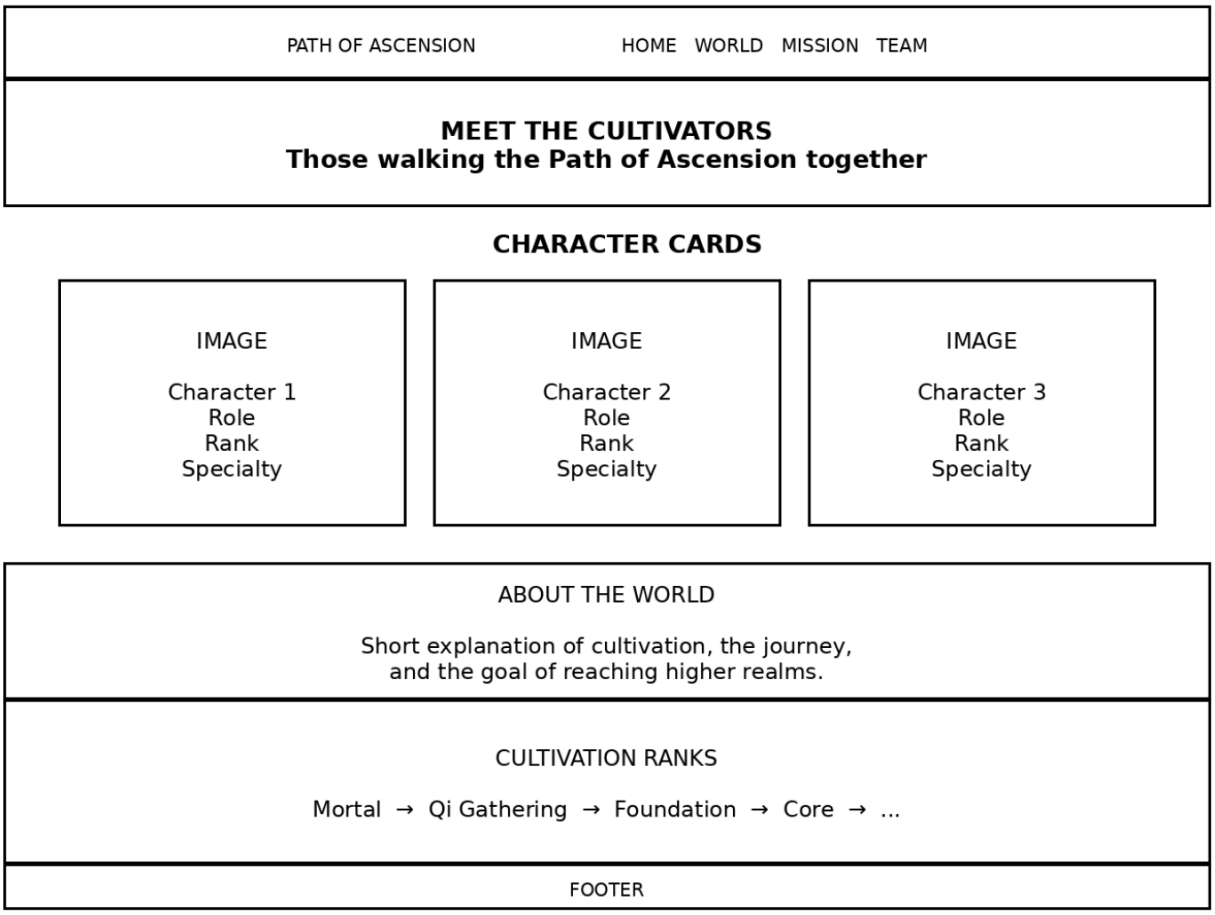
Mission Detail (mission.html)

The Mission Detail page will provide more information about a selected quest. It will display the mission title, location, difficulty or cultivation rank, objectives, potential rewards, and a short description of the challenge. A checkpoint or progress section will show the stages required to complete the mission. This page will use reusable cards, badges, and progress components that share the same visual design as the World Map.



Team/About (team.html)

The Team/About page will introduce the cultivators or characters associated with the journey. Character cards will contain information such as a character's name, role, cultivation rank, and abilities or specialty. The page will also provide additional information about the world and the purpose of the site. This gives users context for the characters participating in the quests while satisfying the Quest Explorer's required Team/About page.



Functionality and User Experience

Screen-to-Screen Use Cases

A user will begin on the **Home page**, where they are introduced to *Path of Ascension* and the cultivator's journey. From the Home page, the user can select **Explore World** to move to the **World Map**.

On the **World Map**, the user can view the different regions of the cultivation world and see their progression status, such as completed, current, or locked. Selecting the current available region or quest will take the user to the **Mission Detail page**.

The **Mission Detail page** will provide the quest description, objectives, rewards, difficulty or rank, and quest checkpoints. The user can return to the World Map to continue exploring the journey.

The **Team/About page** can be accessed through the main navigation from any page. It allows the user to view the cultivators participating in the journey, their roles, cultivation ranks, and specialties.

A consistent navigation bar will appear across all four pages so users can move directly between **Home, World Map, Mission, and Team/About**.

Transitions

We'll plan to use CSS transitions for interactive elements such as **navigation links, buttons, region cards, and character cards**. For example, buttons and cards can smoothly change their appearance when hovered or focused rather than changing instantly.

Transformations

CSS transforms will provide visual feedback without changing the actual page layout. Region and character cards can use a small translateY() effect when hovered, while important buttons can use a subtle scale() effect. These transformations will help indicate which elements are interactive.

Animations

We'll use animations more selectively. The **current checkpoint** on the journey can have a subtle pulse or glow to distinguish it from completed and locked locations. The site can also include a slow atmospheric animation, such as drifting clouds or mist, to support the fantasy environment. The journey/checkpoint system can use a small progression animation to draw attention toward the cultivator's current location.

We'll also include prefers-reduced-motion so these effects can be reduced or disabled for users who request reduced motion, which supports the accessibility requirements in the project rubric.

Iterative Design and Improvement

The website will be developed in stages, beginning with the semantic HTML structure and basic layouts for each page. After the main structure is complete, the team will add the shared visual design, responsive layouts, and CSS interactions and animations. Throughout development, the team will review each page for layout problems, navigation issues, accessibility concerns, and visual consistency. Feedback from team

members and usability testing will be used to make improvements before the final submission.

Usability Testing

The team will test the website to ensure that users can easily understand its purpose and navigate between all four pages. Testing will include checking navigation links, buttons, region and mission interactions, keyboard navigation, visible focus states, text readability, and whether the progression system is understandable without relying only on color.

We will also ask at least one peer to navigate the website and provide feedback about anything that is confusing or difficult to use. Any significant feedback and the resulting changes will be documented.

Responsive Testing

The website will be tested at **mobile, tablet, and desktop screen sizes**. We will check that navigation remains usable, Grid and Flexbox layouts reflow correctly, cards do not overflow or overlap, images resize appropriately, text remains readable, and the World Map/progression system remains understandable on narrow screens.

This is important because the grading rubric specifically evaluates responsive behavior and checks for problems such as overlap, clipping, and unreadable layouts. Project 1 Grading Rubric _ CSC …

Accessibility Testing

The team will check heading structure, semantic HTML landmarks, image alternative text, color contrast, keyboard navigation, visible focus indicators, and reduced-motion support. Animations and transitions will respect the user's prefers-reduced-motion setting.

Validation Plan

The team will validate the HTML and CSS throughout development to identify syntax and structural errors. Each page will also be reviewed for consistent navigation, typography, colors, spacing, reusable components, and responsive behavior. Before submission, all links, images, page layouts, interactions, and animations will be tested to ensure they work consistently across the website. Any errors discovered during validation or testing will be corrected before the final version is submitted.

External Assets and Credits

Any external images, icons, fonts, or other visual assets used in *Path of Ascension* will be obtained from sources that permit their use. The source and appropriate credit for each external asset will be documented in the project README. If an external asset becomes unavailable or cannot be used, a suitable replacement or CSS-based alternative will be used.

Signed Proposal Statement:
We acknowledge the conditions in this proposal, commit to active participation, and understand that individual grades may vary based on contribution and performance.
Name + Signature: Trajuan Smith, TS
Name + Signature: Hien Dao, HD